Request for Information

For

Backflow Program Management Software Solution

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Request for Information No.: **FIN2026-055I**

Issued: **February 4, 2026**

Submission Deadline: **March 3, 2026 at 2:00 PM local time**

1. Introduction

This Request for Information ("RFI") is issued by the City of Barrie (the "City") for the purposes of gathering information about the marketplace in order to assist in the determination of future purchasing options or requirements for a Backflow Program Management Software Solution. Respondents are asked to respond to the City and provide the information requested below.

The City of Barrie is a municipality located in Central Ontario, just over 100 kilometres north of Toronto, on the shores of Kempenfelt Bay, which is the western arm of Lake Simcoe. In 2025, Barrie is home to approximately 159,000 residents, a population that has more than doubled in the past 35 years and is projected to grow to 210,000 people by 2031. As the largest urban center in Simcoe County, Barrie is the economic and employment hub of Central Ontario. As a single-tier municipality, the City is exclusively responsible for providing critical infrastructure and hundreds of services to its residents including roads, water, wastewater, parks, recreation, culture, and many more.

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2. RFI Timetable

Issue Date of RFI	February 4, 2026
Deadline for Questions	February 24, 2026
Deadline for Addenda	February 26, 2026 at 2:00 PM local time
Submission Deadline	March 3, 2026 at 2:00 PM local time

The RFI timetable is tentative. It may be changed by the City at any time, and the City may choose to waive or extend the Deadline for Questions, Deadline for Addenda and/or the Submission Deadline.

3. Background

The City's Water Operations Branch (WOB) is responsible for managing the enforcement of the City of Barrie's Backflow Prevention and Cross Connection Control By-law (By-law 2017-121).

The City's primary goal of this project is to obtain a modern solution which will streamline the process of managing the program, using built-in tools that reduce service demands and response times. By adopting an out of the box and integrated platform, the City aims to enhance its ability to manage services efficiently while improving overall operational oversight.

4. Information Requested

The City of Barrie's Backflow Prevention and Cross Connection Control By-law (2017-121) requires industrial, commercial, institutional, and multi-unit residential properties to install, test, and maintain backflow prevention devices to protect the municipal drinking water supply from contamination. The program aims to prevent pollutants from entering the water system by identifying and eliminating hazardous cross-connections and ensuring compliance through mandatory surveys and Qualified Person (QP) testing. Currently, the program manages approximately 2,600 locations within the City for compliance.

The City is seeking information with regards to available Backflow Prevention and Cross

Connection Control By-law management and records storage software. In addition to file management and storage, the City is interested in exploring other applications and capabilities of software currently on the market, particularly the ability to organize data and provide a user-friendly platform for contractors and property managers.

Responses will be used to help the City identify products and software, conduct market research, and aid in understanding software potential and applications.

Respondents are encouraged to include any additional information, such as images, screenshots, or other diagrams with descriptions to demonstrate the solution's capabilities, that may be of further benefit to communicating the functionalities and features of the described System and application(s) within the **"Additional Information"**, upload section in the Bidding System.

4.1 Program Management Software

The proposed solution must provide a comprehensive suite of program management capabilities to support the administration, monitoring, and enforcement of the City's Backflow Prevention and Cross Connection Control Program. At a minimum, the software should include the following features:

a) Ability to manage QPs Registry, including tracking of certification status, recertification dates, proof of insurance and verification of test kit calibration records. The system should provide automated reminders for upcoming expirations to ensure ongoing compliance.
b) The ability to track and oversee all properties subject to the by-law, including records of each location's backflow devices, compliance status, outstanding requirements and historical activity.
c) Comprehensive way to manage property information, including contact details for owners, managers and authorized agents, as well as any relevant notes for program staff.
d) Full lifecycle management of backflow prevention devices, including installation dates, serial numbers, device types, and test due dates. The system should permit automated scheduling and notification of upcoming or overdue tests.
e) Secure storage and management of test reports, surveys, and supporting documentation, with the ability to upload, review, validate, and archive records efficiently.
f) Support for integrated online forms, enabling contractors, QPs, and property owners to submit documents electronically through structured forms that feed directly into the system.
g) Capability to integrate with the City's existing SAP billing platform, enabling invoicing, reconciliation of payments, and the ability to issue and track charges related to compliance activities, registrations, and administrative fees.
h) An internal dashboard that provides program staff with quick access to operational information, including automated generation and distribution of notifications, compliance reminders, test requests, and other program correspondence. The system should also support workflow automation to reduce manual processing and enhance operational efficiency.

4.2 Customer Service Features

To support external stakeholders and promote ease of compliance, the software should include

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customer-facing digital tools designed for accessibility, transparency, and efficiency. Required features include:

a) An external contractor portal that allows QP's to submit test reports, surveys, calibration certificates, insurance documentation, and payment for QP certification or renewal. The portal should provide status updates, submission history, and automated confirmation of received documents.
b) A dedicated property manager portal that enables owners, operators, and authorized representatives to view device status, upcoming test requirements, outstanding deficiencies, compliance notices, and documentation associated with each property under their responsibility.

4.3 Data Management Reporting

The City requires a solution with strong analytical, reporting, and governance capabilities to support operational oversight and ensure compliance with regulatory and internal standards. The system must include:

a) An internal dashboard providing real-time operational and compliance insights, including submission volume, program trends, and performance metrics.
b) The vendor shall provide details regarding ongoing technical support, including service levels, issue resolution processes, and available training resources.
c) The vendor shall clearly identify where data is stored (e.g., on-premises, Canadian cloud, external data center), including compliance with applicable data governance and privacy legislation.
d) The vendor shall clearly define data ownership, confirming that all data collected, generated, or maintained through the platform remains the property of the City.

4.4 Pricing Model and Deployment

a) Provide a typical cost structure (i.e. enterprise, per user, per transaction, etc.) for the System/products, annual licensing, and implementation (no specific pricing is to be entered).
b) Are there any additional costs or fees the City should be aware of (e.g., delivery, setup, storage, transition out)?
c) What is the typical implementation timeline for the System for an organization of a similar size to the City?
d) Explain the customer support options as part of the deployment.

5. Bidding System Registration

Respondents must register with the City's electronic bidding system at Bids and Tenders (the "Bidding System").

This will enable the respondent to download the RFI, to receive addenda email notifications, download addenda and to submit their response electronically through the Bidding System.

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6. Questions

Respondents may ask questions about this RFI through the Bidding System using the “Submit a Question” link associated with this RFI.

7. Submission Materials

Responses should include a completed and signed Respondent Submission Form (Appendix A) that acknowledges, among other things, that this RFI and any respondent submissions will not create a legal relationship or obligation regarding the procurement of any good or service.

8. Submission Instructions

Please submit your response electronically through the City’s Bidding System.

Responses should be uploaded and finalized prior to the Submission Deadline set out in the RFI Timetable. The Bidding System will send a confirmation email to the respondent advising that their response was successfully received.

Respondents are advised that transmission of responses can be delayed due to file transfer size, transmission speed and other issues and are encouraged to allow sufficient time to upload their responses.

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APPENDIX A – RESPONDENT SUBMISSION FORM

(To be completed in Bidding System)

1. Terms of Reference

In responding to this RFI, the respondent acknowledges its acceptance of the following RFI Terms of Reference:

a. Request for Information Not a Formal Competitive Bidding Process

This RFI is issued for information-gathering purposes and is not intended to be a formal legally binding "Contract A" bidding process. Without limiting the generality of the foregoing, this RFI will not necessarily result in any subsequent negotiations, direct contract award, invitational tendering process or open tendering process, and does not constitute a commitment by the City to procure any goods or services.

b. RFI Not to Limit the City's Pre-existing Rights

This RFI will not limit any of the City's pre-existing rights. Without limiting the generality of the foregoing, the City expressly reserves the right, at its discretion, to:

(i) seek subsequent information or initiate discussions with any potential supplier, including potentials suppliers that did not respond to this RFI;

(ii) initiate direct negotiations for the procurement of any good or service with any potential supplier or suppliers, regardless of whether the potential supplier or suppliers responded to this RFI;

(iii) contact a limited number of potential suppliers, which may include only those that responded to this RFI or may include potential suppliers that did not respond to this RFI, for the purpose of a competitive process for the procurement of any good or service;

(iv) elect to proceed by way of open tender call where all potential respondents, including those that did not respond to this RFI, are eligible to compete for the award of a contract for the supply of any good or service; and

(v) elect not to procure the good or service that is the subject of this RFI.

These expressly reserved rights are in addition to any and all other rights of the City that existed prior to the issuance of this RFI.

c. Pricing Information for General Information Purposes Only

Any pricing information provided by respondents is for general information purposes and is not intended to be binding on respondents. Any legally binding pricing or purchasing commitments will be established only where specified by the express terms of a subsequent tender call process or where established through the execution of a written agreement.

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d. Information in RFI Only an Estimate

The City and its advisers make no representation, warranty or guarantee as to the accuracy of the information contained in the RFI or issued by way of addenda. Any quantities shown or data contained in this RFI, or provided by way of addenda, are estimates provided only as general background information.

e. Parties to Bear Their Own Costs

The City will not be liable for any expenses incurred by a respondent, including the expenses associated with the cost of preparing responses to this RFI. The parties will bear their own costs associated with or incurred through this RFI process, including any costs arising out of, or incurred in, (i) the preparation and issuance of this RFI; (ii) the preparation and making of a submission; or (iii) any other activities related to this RFI process.

f. Accuracy of Responses

The respondent acknowledges that the information provided is, to the best of its knowledge, complete and accurate.

g. Submissions Will Not Be Returned

Except where set out to the contrary in this RFI or expressly requested in the respondent's submission, the submission and any accompanying documentation provided by a respondent will not be returned.

h. Confidential Information of the City

All information provided by or obtained from the City in any form in connection with this RFI either before or after the issuance of this RFI (i) is the sole property of the City and must be treated as confidential; (ii) is not to be used for any purpose other than replying to this RFI; (iii) must not be disclosed without prior written authorization from the City; and (iv) must be returned by the respondent to the City immediately upon the request of the City.

The respondent may not at any time directly or indirectly communicate with the media in relation to this RFI without first obtaining the written permission of the City.

i. Disclosure of Information

The respondent consents to the City's collection of information as contemplated under the RFI for the uses contemplated under the RFI. Respondents should not include information in their response that is proprietary or confidential. Information provided by a respondent may be released in accordance with governing laws. To the extent that a respondent does include confidential or proprietary information, the respondent should identify any information in its submission or any accompanying documentation supplied in confidence for which confidentiality is to be maintained by the City. The confidentiality of such information will be maintained by the City, except where

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an order by a tribunal or court requires the City to do otherwise. The respondent consents to the disclosure, on a confidential basis, of this submission by the City to advisers retained by the City for the purpose of reviewing this submission.

The respondent acknowledges that the City may make public the name of any and all respondents.

j. Governing Law

This RFI process will be governed by and construed in accordance with the City of Barrie Procurement By-law 2024-075 and all associated procedures and protocols, as amended, the laws of the province of Ontario and the federal laws of Canada applicable therein.

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FIN2026-055I - Backflow Program Management Software Solution

Opening Date: February 4, 2026 2:00 PM

Closing Date: March 3, 2026 2:00 PM

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Specifications

Specifications are defined in the Bid document.

Respondent Information

Description	Respondent's Response	
Contact Name:		*
Contact Title:		*
Contact Phone:		*
Contact Fax:		
Contact Email:		*
Legal Company Name (as per HST Registration Number):		
HST Registration Number:		
Business Identification Number (BIN):		

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Documents

It is your responsibility to make sure the uploaded file(s) is/are not defective or corrupted and are able to be opened and viewed by the Owner. If the attached file(s) cannot be opened or viewed, your Bid Call Document may be rejected.

Bidders are encouraged to upload additional material, samples of the software etc.

- Additional Information * (mandatory)

Appendix A Submission Form

1. Terms of Reference

In responding to this RFI, the respondent acknowledges its acceptance of the following RFI Terms of Reference:

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The respondent acknowledges that the City may make public the name of any and all respondents.

j. Governing Law

This RFI process will be governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of the province of Ontario and the federal laws of Canada applicable therein.

☐ I/WE agree to be bound by the terms and conditions and have authority to bind the Corporation and submit this Bid on behalf of the Bidder.

The bidder/proponent/respondent must declare all potential Conflicts of Interest, as defined in the solicitation document. This includes disclosing the names and all pertinent details of all individuals (employees, advisers, or individuals acting in any other capacity) who (a) participated in the preparation of the bid/proposal/response; **AND** (b) were employees of the City within twelve (12) months prior to the Submission Deadline.

If the bidder/proponent/respondent clicks "No", the bidder/proponent/respondent will be deemed to declare that (a) there was no Conflict of Interest in preparing its submission; and (b) there is no foreseeable Conflict of Interest in performing the contractual obligations contemplated in the solicitation document.

Do you have any actual or potential Conflict of Interest to declare?

○ **Yes** ○ **No**

The Bidder acknowledges and agrees that the addendum/addenda below form part of the Bid Document

Please check the box in the column "**I have reviewed this addendum"** below to acknowledge each of the addenda.

File Name	I have reviewed the below addendum and attachments (if applicable)	Pages
There have not been any addenda issued for this bid.		

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